

Lesson 24: "This Is Life Eternal"

Purpose: To encourage us to be receptive to the influence of the Holy Ghost and to draw nearer to Heavenly Father and Jesus Christ.

Naida Stephens Tims "[An Honored and Invited Guest](#)," *Ensign*, June 2007

1. Jesus promises his Apostles that they will receive the gift of the Holy Ghost.

- [John 16:1-15](#) The gift of the Holy Ghost

"The Twelve Apostles experienced manifestations of the Holy Ghost during Jesus' mortal ministry, but they did not receive the gift of the Holy Ghost until after his death and resurrection ([John 20:22](#))."*(Lesson Manual)*

What is the difference between a manifestation of the Holy Ghost and the gift of the Holy Ghost?

What is the Mission of the Holy Ghost?

- See [John 14:26](#); [John 15:26](#); [John 16:13-14](#)

How has receiving the Holy Ghost helped you?

➡ 1. Elder Dallin H. Oaks

How can we be worthy of the Holy Ghost's constant companionship?

How can we recognize the influence of the Holy Ghost?

➡ 2. Elder Boyd K. Packer

➡ 3. "In a dream ..."

➡ 4. Stephen R. Covey

➡ 5. Parley P. Pratt

2. Jesus foretells his death and resurrection.

- [John 16:16-33](#) Jesus prophecies of his death and resurrection

What do you think it means to have peace in him?

What can we learn in John 16 that can help us have peace in him?

- See [Philippians 4:7-9](#); [D&C 59:23](#)

How can the knowledge that Jesus has overcome the world help us be of good cheer?

Why is it important to be of good cheer?

3. Jesus offers the great intercessory prayer.

- [John 17](#) The Intercessory Prayer in the Garden of Gethsemane

- [John 17:1-2](#) Jesus describes his mission

- [John 17:3](#) "This is life eternal that they might know thee ..."

How is knowing Heavenly Father and Jesus Christ different from merely knowing *about* them?

How can we come to know them?

- See [1 John 4:7-8](#); [Mosiah 5:10-13](#); [Alma 22:18](#); [D&C 18:33-36](#); [D&C 132:21-24](#)

- [John 14:7](#) Knowing Christ better helps us know the Father

- [John 17:4-8](#) Giving an accounting to God, the Father, in prayer

How do we report our efforts to Heavenly Father?

How might it affect our choices if we included a report of the day in our prayers daily?

For whom did Jesus pray?

How can we live in the world and be "not of the world?"

- See [John 17:14-16](#)

➡ 6. Elder M. Russell Ballard

How are Heavenly Father and Jesus Christ "one," as stated in [John 17:21-22](#)?

➡ 7. President Gordon B. Hinckley

Why do we need unity with Heavenly Father and Jesus Christ?

Within our families? With other Church members?

How can we increase unity in these relationships?

- See [John 17:26](#); [Mosiah 18:21](#); [D&C 35:2](#)

How do you feel when you know someone has been praying for you?

(The Life and Teachings of Jesus and His Apostles: Course Manual (Religion 211-212).)

Next Week: New Testament Lesson 25: "Love One Another, As I Have Loved You"

Luke 22:1-38; John 13-15

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→ **1. Elder Dallin H. Oaks:** “Manifestations of the Holy Ghost are given to lead sincere seekers to gospel truths that will persuade them to repentance and baptism. The gift of the Holy Ghost is more comprehensive.... [It] includes the right to constant companionship, that we may ‘always have his Spirit to be with [us]’ [D&C 20:77](#)).

“A newly baptized member told me what she felt when she received that gift. This was a faithful Christian woman who had spent her life in service to others. She knew and loved the Lord, and she had felt the manifestations of His Spirit. When she received the added light of the restored gospel, she was baptized and the elders placed their hands upon her head and gave her the gift of the Holy Ghost. She recalled, ‘I felt the influence of the Holy Ghost settle upon me with greater intensity than I had ever felt before. He was like an old friend who had guided me in the past but now had come to stay.’” (“[Always Have His Spirit](#),” Nov. 1996, 60)

→ **2. Elder Boyd K. Packer:** “The Holy Ghost speaks with a voice that you *feel* more than you *hear*. It is described as a ‘still small voice.’ And while we speak of ‘listening’ to the whisperings of the Spirit, most often one describes a spiritual prompting by saying, ‘I had a *feeling* ...’ ... Revelation comes as words we *feel* more than *hear*.” (“[Personal Revelation: The Gift, the Test, and the Promise](#),” *Ensign*, Nov. 1994, 60)

→ **3. “In a dream** given to President Brigham Young, the Prophet Joseph Smith instructed him to teach the Saints that ‘the Spirit of the Lord ... will whisper peace and joy to their souls; it will take malice, hatred, strife and all evil from their hearts; and their whole desire will be to do good, bring forth righteousness and build up the kingdom of God.’” (*Manuscript History of Brigham Young, 1846-1847*, comp. Elden J. Watson [1971], 529).

→ **4. Stephen R. Covey:** “To daily and prayerfully read the scriptures will enable us to divide truth and error in our lives, to tear down the contention and craftiness of men, to be like a rod of iron, guiding us along the path of righteousness. And when the mists of darkness or the temptations of Satan surround us so that we cannot see that strait path, we can rely upon the scriptures and the counsel of our present prophets—the word of God—and we can feast upon it every day of our lives.” (“Build on the True Foundation—Christ in You,” *BYU Speeches of the Year*, Feb 22, 1966, 9)

→ **5. Elder Parley P. Pratt:** “The gift of the Holy Ghost ... quickens all the intellectual faculties, increases, enlarges, expands and purifies all the natural passions and affections; and adapts them, by the gift of wisdom, to their lawful use. It inspires, develops, cultivates and matures all the fine-toned sympathies, joys, tastes, kindred feelings and affections of our nature. It inspires virtue, kindness, goodness, tenderness, gentleness and charity. It develops beauty of person, form and features. It tends to health, vigor, animation and social feeling. It invigorates all the faculties of the physical and intellectual man. It strengthens, and gives tone to the nerves. In short, it is, as it were, marrow to the bone, joy to the heart, light to the eyes, music to the ears, and life to the whole being.” ([Key to the Science of Theology](#), 101-102)

→ **6. Elder M. Russell Ballard:** “In the Church, we often state the couplet, ‘Be in the world but not of the world.’ As we observe television shows that make profanity, violence, and infidelity commonplace and even glamorous, we often wish we could lock out the world in some way and isolate our families from it all....

“Perhaps we should state the couple previously mentioned as two separate admonitions. First, ‘*Be in the world.*’ Be involved; be informed. Try to be understanding and tolerant and to appreciate diversity. Make meaningful contributions to society through service and involvement. Second, ‘*Be not of the world.*’ Do not follow wrong paths or bend to accommodate or accept what is not right.

“We should strive to change the corrupt and immoral tendencies in television and in society by keeping things that offend and debase out of our homes. In spite of all the wickedness in the world, and in spite of all the opposition to good that we find on every hand, we should not try to take ourselves or our children *out* of the world. Jesus said, ‘The kingdom of heaven is like unto leaven,’ or yeast ([Matthew 13:33](#)). We are to lift the world and help all to rise above the wickedness that surrounds us. The Savior prayed to the Father:

“‘I pray not that thou shouldest take them out of the world, but that thou shouldest keep them from evil.’” ([John 17:15](#))” (“[The Effects of Television](#),” *Ensign*, May 1989, 80)

→ **7. President Gordon B. Hinckley:** Speaking of Heavenly Father, Jesus Christ, and the Holy Ghost, “They are distinct beings, but they are one in purpose and effort. They are united as one in bringing to pass the grand, divine plan for the salvation and exaltation of the children of God.... It is that perfect unity between the Father, the Son, and the Holy Ghost that binds these three into the oneness of the divine Godhead.” (“[The Father, Son, and Holy Ghost](#),” *Ensign*, Nov. 1986, 51)